

Examiner reports

Q1.

Some students were very familiar with how to take a simple random sample and gave a full and clear explanation of the method required. Some students, however, simply defined what a simple random sample is earning no credit. Some students were not familiar with this method of sampling at all and resorted to taking either systematic or cluster samples.

Drawing names from a hat was given little credit (lack of practicality for a sample of 3200). Schools and colleges need to encourage their students to use their calculators to obtain random numbers.

Students who broke the technique down into stages were most successful, although some did not state that either 4 digit random numbers were required excluding any above 3200 or numbers had to be chosen between 1 and 3200 (or 0 and 3199)

Q2.

The majority of students correctly identified the sampling method in (a).

Unfortunately, in (b) the vast majority of students failed to identify the problem with the sample as being that it was not random. Most students showed they understood the idea of a hypothesis test, though a greater number this time were unable to correctly state the hypotheses from which the solution follows. It is important that students are aware of the importance of concluding in context which most, but not all, managed to do.

Q6.

Most candidates scored 0 or 3 on this question.

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